

DESKMATE: PRODUCT BACKGROUND AND MARKETING STRATEGY

The DeskMate® Graphical User Interface was first developed by Tandy Corporation to provide an easy-to-use means of working with computers. It was bundled with a series of simple applications to introduce new users to the broad functionality that computers offer.

The DeskMate system consists of three components--the DeskMate Interface, the DeskMate Desktop, and a group of integrated productivity applications.

The DeskMate Interface includes a menu bar, pull-down menus, dialog boxes, and help system that together provide a common and familiar command structure for diverse software applications.

The DeskMate Desktop is a user-configurable graphical menuing system, operating system shell, and means of activating the DeskMate accessories. The user may add any DeskMate or non-DeskMate (MS-DOS® operating system) programs to the Desktop. As a shell, the Desktop brings point-and-click ease-of-use to the most common MS-DOS commands, such as formatting or copying a floppy diskette, running other software programs, and file and directory management.

The Tandy integrated applications and accessories include a word processor, spreadsheet, data manager, calendar program, drawing program, alarm, calculator, spell checker, phone list and more.

Since its introduction in 1984, DeskMate has evolved into a graphically-oriented user interface, providing a consistent look and feel to diverse applications from a wide array of software publishers. With DeskMate's standard set of pull-down menus, pop-up dialogue boxes, and keyboard and mouse commands, learning one DeskMate application means the user already knows how to use other DeskMate applications.

On March 28, 1988, Tandy announced licensing of the DeskMate interface to software developers on a non-exclusive, royalty-free basis. In the 16 months since that announcement, DeskMate has garnered the support of more than 100 licensees. Already, 23 applications are listed in the 1990 Tandy® Computer Catalog.

Designed for 8088, 8086 and 80286-based personal computers, DeskMate does not require an expensive hardware investment, allowing some applications to operate with as little as 384 kilobytes of memory on floppy disk-based computers. It is compatible with industry-standard MS-DOS machines, including portables, and supports the standard video modes, CGA, MCGA, EGA, VGA, Tandy* 1000 and Hercules.

With the addition of DeskMate Workgroup Companion™, the functionality of shared resources is available through RS-232 serial communications, or NetBIOS-based networks, such as 3Com* or Tandy's cost-effective TandyLink™ adapter.

In 1988, Tandy brought the same user-friendly interface to the education market with SchoolMate™, a powerful yet easy-to-use classroom networking strategy based on the DeskMate Graphical User Interface using either the TandyLink or 3Com networks. SchoolMate is an integrated collection of teacher centered applications and utilities. Classroom management applications include Roster, Grade Book, Lesson Scheduler and Exam Maker. There are 65 additional education-specific applications, that run on the SchoolMate network, available through Radio Shack* outlets nationwide.

The significance of Tandy's DeskMate strategy is that it provides users of low-cost personal computers with a degree of simplicity and user friendliness previously available only on more expensive computer systems. Tandy, and other DeskMate supporters, expect this strategy to significantly expand the market for low-cost personal computers in the home, home office, school and general business markets.

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DeskMate 3 Applications

The following products are shown in the 1990 Tandy Computer Catalog.

NEW! Lotus Spreadsheet for DeskMate	Lotus Development Corporation
NEW! Q&A Write	Symantec
The Music Studio	Activision
Memory Mate	Broderbund
DacEasy 4.0 Accounting--DeskMate	DAC Software
Instant Pages	Electronic Arts
Print Magic	Epyx
Computer MAD LIBS	First Byte
KidTalk	First Byte
Math Talk	First Byte
SmoothTalker	First Byte
Speller Bee	First Byte
Quicken	Intuit
PC-Link	Quantum Computer Services
DeskMate Form Finisher	Power-Up! Software
Homeword II	Sierra On-Line
PFS: First Publisher	Software Publishing Corporation
Venture	Star Software
DeskMate	Tandy Corporation
SchoolMate	Tandy Corporation
Thesaurus	Tandy Corporation
Workgroup Companion	Tandy Corporation
Children's Writing and Publishing Center	The Learning Company